

The Old Report

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FRONT PAGE

Stop Multitasking and Try Timeboxing

Harvard Business Review

There are all kinds of productivity tools out there promising to help you make the most of your day. Some people swear by timeboxing: the method of reserving time on your calendar each day for each task you want to get done, and then truly focusing on that one thing at a time. The return on merging your to-do list with your calendar like this, says Marc Zao-Sanders, is higher productivity, better collaboration, and less distraction and anxiety. He explains how try to the method yourself and the how your team and organization benefit from it, not just you. Zao-Sanders is author of the book “Timeboxing: The Power of Doing One Thing at a Time.”

FEATURES

When pull requests get tricky

Monica Dinculescu

Imagine this: you have forked a repo a long time ago and have since been in a happily committed relationship with the master branch, modifying files and committing from the hip.

In case you have doubts about the likelihood of this scenario, we're talking about my notwaldorf.github.com blog branch, which I forked from holman/left. All my changes are on the master branch so that GitHub can do its magic gh-pages trick and just Make Things Work™. This could also happen for repos you've forked and mucked around with, but never thought you'd ever contribute to.

Because you're a good open sorcerer, you might, at some point, want to send a pull request to fix a thing in the original repo. If you're anything like I am, you are now in a bit of a terrible situation because your fork's tip of tree has advanced and diverged quite a bit from the upstream repo, so any pull requests you send out will be polluted with code that doesn't belong in them.

At this point, you probably have some regrets. Let's not dwell on them. Here's the set of steps that will help you navigate this minefield you find yourself in. They're not special; I just couldn't find them all in one place, and wanted a summary for the future. Kamal figured most of this out, because he is a git wizard, while I am, most definitely, not.

Set up your upstream

If git remote doesn't show you a branch called upstream, you need to add one:

```
git remote add upstream https://github.com/user/repo_you_forked.git
```

Set up a clean branch for your fix

Step into your tardis and branch from when you were last in sync with the upstream. In my case, this was when I initially created my fork. A dull perusing of git log or git reflog should point you to the right sha. Then,

```
git checkout -b pr_branch git reset --hard sha_from_the_past
```

Get your changes in

Here you have two options. If your changes are tiny, or you know exactly what they are, you can just manually reapply them. And by that I mean copy paste the changes into the right files, like a barbarian. For the record, this is my preferred approach. I am a barbarian. I live in the git stone age.

Alternatively, you can go the fancy route with

```
git checkout -p master file_to_modify
```

This will look at the diff between master (which is in the future), and your working copy (we are in the past) and let you pick and choose individual hunks. Having taken a moment and appreciated how amazing this last sentence was, you can:

hit s to split the hunks into smaller hunks

hit y or n to pick or skip a hunk.

If you've touched any files, it would be a good time to do your familiar git add/git commit dance.

Merge the upstream changes in

```
git fetch upstream # You won't see any changes in git log.
Don't panic yet. git merge upstream/master # Some wild upstream changes appear in git log.
```

♪ ♪ T-t-t-test your cha-an-ges ♪ ♪

Upload your branch

This is the last step. If you want, you can rename your branch before uploading it. I usually do, because my original branch names tend to be silly. After this, you can go and look at your branch in GitHub and be delighted with the progress you've made. Time to send out that pull request!

```
git push origin pr_branch:possibly_new_branch_name
```

Hope this helped!

A dull perusing of git log or git reflog should point you to the right sha.

Monica Dinculescu

Comedian Sarah Cooper On Bringing Humor to Any Career

Harvard Business Review

It's a cliché, but they say it's best to write what you know. That was the case for comedian Sarah Cooper, who rose to viral social media fame in the Trump era through her lip sync TikTok videos. She formerly worked at Yahoo and Google, and she found her way into comedy, in part, by looking at and pointing out the absurdities of corporate culture. She speaks about how humor helped her manage a team, why she took the big risk to quit her job, and how she's navigating the new work world of Hollywood. Cooper is the author of the forthcoming audio book "Let's Catch Up Soon: How I Won Friends and Influenced People Against My Will."

Why Companies Should Stop Political Spending Now

Harvard Business Review

A decade ago, the U. S. Supreme Court changed the rules on how businesses could donate to political campaigns. Since then, hundreds of millions of corporate dollars have been spent on local, state, and federal elections, often without transparency. Many CEOs and boards feel this is the only way they can curry favor with policymakers. Dorothy Lund, an associate professor of law at the University of Southern California, and Leo Strine Jr., counsel at Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen, and Katz and a former Chief Justice of the Supreme Court of Delaware, say this isn't just bad for democracy. It's bad for business because it distracts companies from innovation and growth and risks serious backlash from consumers, employees, and shareholders. They suggest ways to dial back corporate political spending and improve the economy for all.

They are the authors of the HBR article "Corporate Political Spending is Bad Business: How to Minimize the Risks and Focus on What Counts."

IN BRIEF

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Joshua Gans, a professor at the University of Toronto's Rotman School of Management, advises against trying to commercialize a new technology or product before considering all the strategic options. He talks through some questions entrepreneurs should ask themselves — like, collaborate or compete? — and outlines a framework he and his fellow researchers have found to work best for startups. Gans is the coauthor of the article "Do Entrepreneurs Need a Strategy?"

Bloomberg, Bloomberg: A Palestinian flag is raised as Houthis rally in solidarity with Iran and Lebanon, in Sanaa, Yemen, on March 27, 2026.

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Gary Hamel and Michele Zanini, cofounders of the consultancy Management Lab, say that even though we all lament how rigid, parochial, and time sucking bureaucracies can be, they still seem inescapable. The managers who've excelled in them often don't know how to dismantle them — or else they don't want to. But Zanini and Hamel have studied and collaborated with innovative organizations, and they outline bottom-up ways to empower workers and hack management. Hamel and Zanini wrote the new book "Humanocracy: Creating Organizations as Amazing as the People Inside them."

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley, Gastropod: Cue the dramatic music, it's quiz time: Can you identify the people behind these catchphrases? "Yum-O!" "Pukka!" "Bam!" "Peace, love, and taco grease!" The answers are below—but if you've already caught on, then you're well aware of how entrenched TV chefs are in mainstream pop culture. But how did a medium where you can't actually smell or taste the food get so popular? What was the very first food TV show, and how has food TV changed—and changed us? Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Gretchen Rubin, author of "Better than Before: Mastering the Habits of Our Everyday Lives," explains that you've got to know your habit-setting style.

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Jeff Busgang, a venture capitalist who teaches entrepreneurship at Harvard Business School, knows from personal experience and having funded many startups that there's more than one way into that world. You don't have to have a technical background. Excellent communication skills and a high emotional IQ are startup skills, too. Busgang, the author of "Mastering the Art of the Deal," explains the importance of finding your human capital and how to build a strong team. He also discusses the importance of understanding your market and how to use data to make decisions. He also discusses the importance of understanding your market and how to use data to make decisions.

Summer School 7: Negotiating and the empathetic nibble

NPR Planet Money

How do you get the best deal? How do you know you're getting the best deal? Whether you're talking down the price of a car or talking up your salary, you don't have to be a jerk to get what you want. Negotiations can be win-win – if you know what to ask for and how to grow the pie.

We have three stories in today's episode about how to negotiate tactically. First, a hostage negotiator tries to buy a car. Will he get far? Then, one man's encounter at the airline ticket booth may inform how you respond to your next job offer. Finally, how to avoid a food fight and make a deal that benefits everybody.

We'll learn about something called BATNA, or best alternative to a negotiated agreement, which can tell you when to stand firm and when to walk away. We'll find out how to shift our thinking about what success can look like in a negotiation, and shift your counterpart's thinking too.

Come learn the techniques of expert negotiators in the penultimate episode of Planet Money Summer School, MBA edition. Next week: Graduation! So, you have one week to negotiate the cost of your cap and gown.

Our Summer School series is hosted by Robert Smith and produced by Max Freedman. Our project manager is Julia Carney. This episode was edited by our executive producer, Alex Goldmark, and engineered by James Willetts.

The show was fact-checked by Sierra Juarez.

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What AI data centers are doing to your electric bill

NPR Planet Money

As a country, we are spending more to get data centers up and running than we spent to build the entire interstate highway system. (Yes, that's inflation-adjusted.) With tech companies spending hundreds of billions of dollars on AI, data centers have kind of become the thing in the US economy.

But along with that growth have come a lot of questions. Like where is all the electricity to run these data centers supposed to come from? And how much are residential customers' electric bills increasing as a result?

On today's episode, we go to Ohio to trace one electric bill back to its source, to see what exactly is causing the big price increases people are seeing. We take a tour of a data center hot spot, and get to the bottom of how prices are set from inside the power company.

Related episodes:

- Asking for a friend ... which jobs are safe from AI?
- No AI data centers in my backyard!
- What \$10 billion in data centers actually gets you
- Is AI overrated or underrated?
- Green energy gridlock

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Today's show was hosted by Keith Romer and Jeff Guo. It was produced by Sam Yellowhorse Kesler. It was edited by Jess Jiang and fact checked by Sierra Juarez and Vito Emanuel. It was engineered by Cena Loffredo. Alex Goldmark is Planet Money 's executive producer.

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Goodbye Bureaucracy, Hello Common Sense

Harvard Business Review

Martin Lindstrom, founder and chairman of Lindstrom Company, says that many companies are still held back by doing things the way they've always done them, or failing to break down bureaucracy. For Lindstrom, it's not just about getting away from bureaucratic norms for the sake of innovation, but because so many things workers do each and every day don't actually make much sense. He suggests workers, leaders, and organizations consider ways in which processes can be improved - and the ways these new processes can improve life for everyone. And he argues that companies should actually devote a team or department to making sure common sense is used throughout the organization.

Lindstrom is the author of the book "The Ministry of Common Sense: How to Eliminate Bureaucratic Red Tape, Bad Excuses, and Corporate BS."

No Scrubs: Breeding a Better Bull

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

In 1900, the average dairy cow in America produced 424 gallons of milk each year. By 2000, that figure had more than quadrupled, to 2,116 gallons. In this episode of Gastropod, we explore the incredible science that transformed the American cow into a milk machine—but we also uncover the disturbing history of prejudice and animal cruelty that accompanied it.

Along the way, we'll introduce you to the insane logic of the Lifetime Cheese Merit algorithm and the surreal bull trials of the 1920s. This is the untold story behind that most wholesome and quotidian of beverages: milk. Prepare to be horrified and amazed in equal measure. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

How to Get Better at Saying No

Harvard Business Review

The Consumer Psychology of Adopting AI

Harvard Business Review

Despite all the ways that artificial intelligence promises to improve our lives, many consumers feel anxious and are averse to AI-powered products and services. For marketers and product managers, it's vital to understand what is driving that resistance to adoption. Julian De Freitas is an assistant professor in the marketing unit at Harvard Business School. He has identified five main ways people see artificial intelligence negatively: that AI is opaque, emotionless, inflexible, autonomous, and not human enough. Through real-life cases and the latest research, he explains how companies can soothe anxieties and encourage consumer adoption. De Freitas is the author of the HBR article "Why People Resist Embracing AI."

Introducing 4 Business Ideas That Changed the World

Harvard Business Review

Influential business and management ideas have tremendous influence over us. Like it or not, they shape how organizations are run and how people around the world spend their days. And Harvard Business Review has introduced and spread many of these consequential ideas since its founding in 1922.

HBR IdeaCast is taking this 100th anniversary to ask: how have these ideas changed our lives? And where are they taking us in the future? Each Thursday in October, the podcast feed will feature a bonus series: 4 Business Ideas That Changed the World.

Each week, a different HBR editor talks to world-class scholars and experts on influential business and management ideas of HBR's first 100 years: disruptive innovation, scientific management, shareholder value, and emotional intelligence.

Listen to the conversations to better understand our work life, how far it's come, and how far it still has to go.

Tiki Time!

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Our families, schools, and workplaces often train us to comply: taking on additional work when asked, agreeing with the group's consensus, and going along to get along with our bosses and colleagues. So, even when we're told to "think different" and "embrace conflict," we often hold ourselves back. But when individuals learn to say no more often, it can have huge benefits for their careers and organizations, says Dr. Sunita Sah. A psychologist and professor at Cornell's SC Johnson College of Business, she shares a research-backed framework for evaluating whether to comply or defy at work and offers advice on how to do both more effectively. Sah is author of the book *Defy: The Power of No In a World That Demands Yes*.

Tiki bars are hot these days: you can enjoy a fruity tropical drink while surrounded by faux-Polynesian décor in most major cities around the U. S. and elsewhere, with new tiki spots opening every month. The trend is a revival of a nearly century-old American tradition—but the knowledge of how to make these classic tiki cocktails had been all but lost over the intervening decades. It took an amateur sleuth who went on a deep dive into cocktail archaeology and recipe cryptography to bring back the lost flavors. But, while the drinks he rediscovered are delicious, does the classic tiki bar interior, adorned with carvings that resemble traditional Polynesian gods, stand the test of time? Listen in for tales of Hollywood celebrities, backyard luaus, and a savvy restaurateur with a wooden leg.

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The Rest of the Story, 2025

NPR Planet Money

Most stories keep going even after we set down our microphones and the music fades up. That's why, at the end of each year, we look back and we take stock.

We call this tradition "The Rest of the Story." And we bring you updates on the stories we've reported, and from the people we've met along the way.

Today, we check in on an engineer and patent attorney who made a safer saw; we get an update on the Planet Money game; an update on money in Gaza; and we have updates on a diamond that may or may not have had a second life.

Listen to the original stories:

Planet Money buys a mystery diamond

In Gaza, money is falling apart

BOARD GAMES 1: We're making a game

How to save 10,000 fingers

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How to get what Greenland has, with permission

NPR Planet Money

Book tour and ticket info here.

Greenland has said it is not for sale. Denmark has said it can't even legally sell Greenland. And at a security conference in Munich over the weekend, U. S. lawmakers spent a lot of time trying to walk back some of President Trump's recent threats to try to buy, or even take over, the territory.

But whether Trump can or will or should try to control or purchase a territory that doesn't want to be sold is not the interesting question. What is interesting is how we got to this moment. And, how we might gracefully get out of it.

Greenland is valuable for its minerals and because of its physical location in the world. (It's easy to keep an eye on other countries from Greenland).

Our latest: How the U. S. dropped the ball on the rare earths race. And one way the U. S. gets strategic locations without threatening to buy or take over an entire territory.

Further listening:

- Is Greenland really an untapped land of riches?
- Add to cart: Greenland

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This episode was produced by Willa Rubin with help from Sam Yellowhorse Kesler. It was edited by Marianne McCune. Fact-checking help from Sierra Juarez. It was engineered by Kwesi Lee and Robert Rodriguez. Alex Goldmark is our executive producer.

Music: Universal Music Production - "The Attraction," "Carnivore," and "Walls Come Out."

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NPR Planet Money

Move Over Gin, We've Got Tonic Fever

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · *Gastropod*

Just a few decades ago, gin & tonics were considered rather stodgy and boring, the drink of suburbanites at the golf club. Today, the century-old drink is hot again. In part, that's due to a boom in craft gin distilling—a ginaissance! But there's also been a new wave of experimentation with gin's life partner, tonic water. This episode, we focus on the tonic side of the equation. Which genius came up with the idea of combining quinine, a malaria drug, with soda water and sugar in order to create this refreshing beverage? How did the bark of a South American tree end up in everything from hair-restoring shampoo to cocktails? And is it true that the G&T began life as a pleasant way for the Anglo-Indian elite to take their anti-malarials? This episode, we take a sip of tonic's history with Kim Walker and Mark Nesbitt, authors of the new book *Just the Tonic: A Natural History of Tonic Water*. Listen in for all that, plus beef-infused tonic wines, Aperol spritzes, and the gin & tonic's true origin story. Cheers!

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The Vapes of Wrath

NPR Planet Money

When the vape brand Juul first hit the market back in 2015, e-cigarettes were in a kind of regulatory limbo. At the time, the rules that governed tobacco cigarettes did not explicitly apply to e-cigarettes. Then Juul blew up, fueled a public health crisis over teen vaping, and inspired a regulatory crackdown. But when the government finally stepped in to solve the problem of youth vaping, it may have actually made things worse.

Today's episode is a collaboration with the new podcast series "Backfired: the Vaping Wars." You can listen to the full series at audible.com/Backfired.

This episode was hosted by Alexi Horowitz-Ghazi and Leon Neyfakh. It was produced by Emma Peaslee and edited by Jess Jiang with help from Annie Brown. It was fact checked by Sofia Shchukina and engineered by Cena Loffredo. Alex Goldmark is Planet Money's executive producer.

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Ask Gastropod: Bubblegum, Meal Kits, and the Real Truth About Rooibos

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

What do bubblegum, rooibos tea, and meal kits have in common? They're all topics that puzzle and fascinate you, dear Gastropod listeners. This episode, we're getting to the bottom of your most pressing culinary questions! Such as: Are meal kits really better for the planet than buying and cooking dinner from scratch? Can all the rooibos tea in the world really come from one mountain range in South Africa? And what the heck is bubblegum flavor, anyway? Join us this episode for the scoop on meal kits, a tale of tea-drinking babies, and a peek behind the scenes at the Willy Wonka world of bubblegum flavor development from a real-life bubblegum scientist. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Meet the Most Famous American You've Never Heard Of: His Legacy is Excellent French Fries and Monsanto

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

In his day, Luther Burbank was a horticultural rock star: everyone from opera singers to movie stars and European royalty to an Indian guru traveled to Santa Rosa, California, to meet him. Dubbed the “plant wizard,” Burbank invented the pluot and the stoneless plum, the white blackberry, and the potato variety used in every French fry you've ever eaten—as well as some 800 more new-and-improved plants, from walnuts to rhubarb. His fame as a plant inventor put him in the same league as Thomas Edison—but, while Edison patented his light bulb and phonograph, Burbank had no legal way to protect his crop creations. Listen now for the story of Luther Burbank, the most famous American you've never heard of, and how his struggles shaped what's on our supermarket shelves today, but also led to a world in which big companies like Monsanto can patent life. It's a wild ride that involves the death spiral of the Red Delicious and the rise of the Cosmic Crisp apple, as well as coded notebooks, detective agencies, rogue farmers, and a resistance movement led by former New York City mayor (and subsequent airport namesake) Fiorello La Guardia.

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The trade fraud detective

NPR Planet Money

When David Rashid took over US autoparts maker Plews and Edelmann, the company was losing business to its Chinese rival, Qingdao Sunsong. Both companies make power steering hoses, but Sunsong was offering its hoses to retailers at a much lower price.

Then, in 2018, the Trump administration threw companies like Rashid's a lifeline, by announcing tariffs on a range of Chinese goods, including some autoparts. Rashid thought the tariffs would finally force Sunsong to raise its prices, but, somehow, the company never did.

It was a mystery. And it led Rashid to take on a new role – amateur trade fraud investigator. How could his competitor, Sunsong, absorb that 25% tax without changing its prices? And why had all of Sunsong's steering hoses stopped coming from China and started coming from Thailand?

On today's episode, the wide gulf between how tariffs work in theory... and how they actually work in practice. And David Rashid's quest to figure out what, if anything, he could do about it. It's a quest that will involve international detectives, forensic chemists, and a friendship founded on a shared love for hummus.

This episode was hosted by Keith Romer and Jeff Guo. It was produced by Emma Peaslee and edited by Molly Messick. It was fact-checked by Sierra Juarez

and engineered by Ko Takasugi-Czernowin. Alex Goldmark is our executive producer.

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Easy A: The SuperRad Story of Home Economics

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

If you grew up in the U. S., you might remember home economics class as the source of deflated muffins and horrifically distorted sewing projects. You might, like Jonah Hill's character in *Superbad*, have thought of home ec as "a joke" that everyone takes "to get an A." But it wasn't always so—and, in fact, the field of home economics began as a surprisingly radical endeavor. This episode, we talk with Danielle Dreilinger, author of the new book *The Secret History of Home Economics: How Trailblazing Women Harnessed the Power of Home and Changed the Way We Live*. How did women a century ago use home economics as a backdoor to build careers as scientists? How did home ec trailblazers electrify rural towns, design the modern kitchen, and create the first nutritional guidelines? And what does Sputnik have to do with the field's decline? Can today's home ec once again meet the lofty goals set by its founders?

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And David Rashid's quest to figure out what, if anything, he could do about it.

NPR Planet Money

Inside video game economics (Two Indicators)

NPR Planet Money

Why do video game workers offer labor at a discount? How can you design a video game for blind and sighted players? Does that design have lessons for other industries?

These and other questions about the business of video games answered in today's episode. The Indicator just wrapped a weeklong series decoding the economics of the video game industry, we're excerpting some highlights.

First, we meet some of the workers who are struggling with the heavy demands placed on them in their booming industry, and how they are fighting back.

Then, we check in on how game developers are pulling in new audiences by creatively designing for people who couldn't always play. How has accessibility become an increasingly important priority for game developers? And, how can more players join in the fun?

You can hear the rest of our weeklong series on the gaming industry at this link , or wherever you get your podcasts.

This episode was hosted by Wailin Wong, Darian Woods, and Adrian Ma. Corey Bridges produced this episode with help from James Sneed. It was edited by Kate Concannon, fact-checked by Sierra Juarez, and engineered by Robert Rodriguez with help from Valentina Rodríguez Sánchez. Alex Goldmark is

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Trump's crypto interests (Two Indicators)

NPR Planet Money

Today on the show – our crypto president. Just before President Donald Trump began his second administration in January, he and his business partners launched the \$TRUMP coin. It's a memecoin that quickly raked in hundreds of millions of dollars. And there's a lot of earning potential still left on the table. Is that even legal?

We bring you two stories from our daily show, The Indicator about President Trump and his ties to crypto. First, the Trump coin. We explain what it is, how the real Donald Trump profits from it, and yes, whether this whole crypto scheme is within the law. Then we take a look at Stablecoins: how they work, how they make money, and for whom.

The original episodes from The Indicator were produced by Cooper Katz McKim and Corey Bridges. They were engineered by Harry Paul and Robert Rodriguez. They were fact-checked by Sierra Juarez. Kate Concannon edits the show. This episode of Planet Money was produced by James Sneed and edited by Emma Peaslee. Alex Goldmark is Planet Money 's executive producer.

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The Chicken Tax (Classic)

NPR Planet Money

Note: This episode originally ran in 2015 .

German families in the 60s loved tasty, cheap American-raised chicken that was suddenly coming in after the war. And Americans were loving fun, cheap Volkswagen Beetles. This arrangement was too good to last.

Today on the show, how a trade dispute over frozen chicken parts changed the American auto industry as we know it.

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Week 6

Monica Dinculescu

I skipped week 5 because all I did in the panna cotta was watch 3 seasons of “how to get away with murder”. It’s a terrible show and I’m not ashamed of it.

What is up with that star codex thing? I can’t believe there was a cult of assholes in tech I didn’t know about. I’m obviously not surprised they existed, there’s an asshole under every rock in tech; I’m just surprised I didn’t know about it. I’m a person in the know! I have an invite to Dispo!

I watched the #freebritney documentary and I think that a) the concept of a conservatorship for a grown ass 40 year old woman is fucked and b) her dad being a misogynistic asshole is 80% of the reason she’s on one. Nobody put Kanye in a corner when he was going bonkers; we let him run for president and bought his shitty 20 minute long album to make fun of it and talked about how he prolly needs to take his meds but oh well, famous people amirite. But if a woman goes a bit bonkers and in the process shaves her head (we all know women aren’t allowed to shave their heads), then suddenly she needs to be in a legal monetary prison for life? Rich people waste their money ALL the time, why is she the different one? Makes you think.

I also think it’s the cherry on the cake that because her dad is “managing” her estate she is essentially paying both for her lawyers to try to help her, and for the opposing lawyers to try to screw her.

I’ve been working on a lot of generative art. This is good, because I’m making things and I want to open a store so people can put my things on their walls, but bad because when I make art and keep looking at it I end up violently hating it, and that spirals out of control into a “everything I do is basic and derivative” mood which tbh makes me feel like shit. I had a nice chat with @mrmrs who is 100x more talented than me but feels similarly about his art sometimes, so I felt very seen.

We drove to Arizona this weekend. We are still doing nothing but now it’s nothing around cactuses and the desert. I’ve been trying to find ways to get myself to move more, and I read in Alice’s notes that she tried out geocaching, so I installed an app last night! I thought there would be like a geocache per state, but there’s millions. There are 2 geocaches within a 2 mile walk! If there’s no week 7 notes it’s either because nothing happened or because I died trying to get to this cache. The halting problem is a hell of a thing.

Why is everyone talking about Musk's money?

NPR Planet Money

We've lived amongst Elon Musk headlines for so long now that it's easy to forget just how much he sounds like a sci-fi character. He runs a space company and wants to colonize mars. He also runs a company that just implanted a computer chip into a human brain. And he believes there's a pretty high probability everything is a simulation and we are living inside of it.

But the latest Elon Musk headline-grabbing drama is less something out of sci-fi, and more something pulled from HBO's "Succession."

Elon Musk helped take Tesla from the brink of bankruptcy to one of the biggest companies in the world. And his compensation for that was an unprecedentedly large pay package that turned him into the richest person on Earth. But a judge made a decision about that pay package that set off a chain of events resulting in quite possibly the most expensive, highest stakes vote in publicly traded company history.

The ensuing battle over Musk's compensation is not just another wild Elon tale. It's a lesson in how to motivate the people running the biggest companies that – like it or not – are shaping our world. It's a classic economics problem with a very 2024 twist.

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The Rest of the Story, 2024

NPR Planet Money

After the gift exchange comes another great holiday tradition: returns season. Once again, we are joining the fun in our own Planet Money way. We are returning to stories from years past to see what's changed since we last reported them. It's an episode we call The Rest of the Story.

We have updates on zombie mortgages, student loan forgiveness, Argentina's economy under its self-described anarcho-capitalist president, and the best place in the world to give birth to twins. Plus, a return to... returns.

So while you're looking for that holiday sweater in a better size, or waiting in line to trade in your Dutch oven for an air fryer, take a listen to all our latest little audio gifts. And see you in 2025!

This episode was hosted by Alexi Horowitz-Ghazi. It was produced by Sam Yellowhorse Kesler, and edited by Keith Romer and Jess Jiang. It was fact-checked by Sierra Juarez and engineered by Cena Loffredo. Alex Goldmark is Planet Money's executive producer.

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How refrigeration took over the world

NPR Planet Money

The next time you open your fridge, take a second to behold the miracles inside of it: Raspberries from California, butter from New Zealand, steak from Nebraska. None of that would have been remotely possible before the creation of the cold chain.

The cold chain is the name for the end-to-end refrigeration of our food from farm to truck to warehouse to grocery store and ultimately to our fridges at home. And it's one of the great achievements of the modern world.

On today's show, Nicola Twilley, food journalist and author of *Frostbite: How Refrigeration Changed Our Food, Our Planet, and Ourselves*, tells us the story of how our world got cold, and what that's meant for the economy.

We'll hear about two pioneers of cold: The cheap-skate meat baron Gustavus Swift, and the train-hopping chemist Polly Pennington. And we'll take a look at whether all this refrigeration might have created some new problems.

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Today's episode of Planet Money was hosted by Nick Fountain and Alexi Horowitz-Ghazi. It was produced by James Sneed and edited by Keith Romer. It was fact-checked by Sierra

Juarez and engineered by Valentina Rodríguez Sánchez. Alex Goldmark is Planet Money's executive producer.

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Grounds for Revolution: the Stimulating Story of How Coffee Shaped the World

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

About 400 years ago, a dark and mysterious stranger arrived in Europe and sent the jitters—really, shock waves—through society. That newcomer was the coffee bean, and it's hard to overstate its effects on the world. From its early days as a religious aid to its pivotal role in the founding of the London Stock Exchange, the first scientific society, and even one of the earliest forms of social media, this bitter brown beverage has democratized culture and sparked innovation, all while fueling capitalism and inequality. With the help of Gastropod's own founding godfather, Michael Pollan, as well as a crew of all-star historians, coffee growers, botanists, and coffee scientists, this episode we're telling the story of how coffee has changed everything it touched, from the humble workday to the fate of nations. This is the first of a two-part series on coffee, sponsored by Nespresso: listen now, and then come back in two weeks for the scientific secrets behind the perfect cup.

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The Land of the Duty Free (classic)

NPR Planet Money

(Note: This episode originally ran in 2018.)

Is it really cheaper to shop at an airport Duty Free store? And why are so many of them alike?

In the 1940s, if you were flying from New York City to London or Paris you would find yourself making a pit stop for fuel on the western coast of Ireland. The Shannon airport at the time wasn't much to look at, but the passengers arriving there were movie stars and celebrities, basically the super rich. And the people of Shannon realized pretty quickly that they needed to upgrade the local amenities for their wealthy clientele. They hired a man named Brendan O'Regan to make it happen. Being the quick-thinking entrepreneur that he was, O'Regan convinced the Irish government to create a tax loophole. And thus, duty free stores were born.

Today on the show, we follow the surprising origin of duty free, and try to answer the question: Are they really saving you any money?

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From Trash to Treasure: Why's It So Hard to Save Restaurant Leftovers From the Dumpster?

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Every day, at the end of service, restaurants throw away tons of entirely edible food: heaps of pastries and whole loaves of bread, vegetables chopped but not cooked, noodle dough, fish off-cuts, and more. An estimated 20 billion meals's worth of still edible food overall is tossed every year here in the US, and more than 85 percent of it ends up in the landfill. Meanwhile, more than one in ten Americans are food insecure. So why is it so hard to keep all of that perfectly good food out of the trash and get it onto people's plates instead? This week, we're taking a deep dive into the dumpster (not literally!), to explore the most innovative and surprising new solutions to this toughest of food challenges, including the wizards transforming everything from stale bagels to gallons of banana cream concentrate into a delicious dinner. Did someone order meals, not methane? Oui chef!

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Find Joy in Any Job: How Do I Improve the Role I Have?

Harvard Business Review

A lot of us are feeling unhappy and disengaged at work – and that started long before the pandemic. A big part of the problem, says Marcus Buckingham, is that we don't take the initiative to do more of the tasks that we truly love. After identifying what most energizes and excites you about your current role or employer, you can try a host of strategies to shape your work around those things.

In this special series from HBR, we're looking at how to find love in your work. In this episode, we explain how to shift your current role to focus on what really drives you.

IdeaCast co-host Alison Beard speaks with Marcus Buckingham, head of research on people and performance at the ADP Research Institute and author of the new book *Love + Work*.

The Great Gastropod Pudding Off (encore)

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Four bakers, one evening, and one challenge: Who can steam the best spotted dick? On this week's action-packed episode, Tom Gilliford, Selasi Gbormittah, and Yan Tsou of Great British Bake-Off fame, along with honorary Gastropod member (and Cynthia's partner) Tim Buntel, compete to see who can master this most classic of British puddings for the first-ever Great Gastropod Pudding Off! But what in the world is spotted dick? "It's got nostalgia, mystery, horror, and comedy—it's a perfect British dish," explained British food designer and jellymonger Sam Bompas, who joined us to judge the competition. Listen in as Tom tries to beat his rival Selasi, Yan revives the flavor combination that robbed her of a Bake Off victory, and Tim tests out his Yankee-style pudding on the Brits. While the four bakers duke it out in the kitchen, we dive into the history and science of British pudding to find out what makes a pudding a pudding, the secret ingredient that will give your pud a lovely light texture, and why anyone would name a dessert "spotted dick."

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Why are we so bummed about the economy?

NPR Planet Money

Kale of the Sea

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Call off the search for the new kale: we've found it, and it's called kelp! In this episode of Gastropod, we explore the science behind the new wave of seaweed farms springing up off the New England coast, and discover seaweed's starring role in the peopling of the Americas.

The story of seaweed will take us from a medicine hut in southern Chile to a high-tech seaweed nursery in Stamford, Connecticut, and from biofuels to beer, as we discover the surprising history and bright future of marine vegetables. Along the way, we uncover the role kelp can play in supporting U. S. fishermen, cleaning up coastal waters, and even helping make salmon farms more sustainable. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Baked: How Pot Brownies and Pate de Fruits Fueled an Edible Cannabis Revolution

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Edible cannabis products are hot right now: Snoop's got some, Willie Nelson's got some—even Martha Stewart's making fancy French-style gummies. In states where it's legal, you can buy everything from marshmallows to macarons, all laden with THC, the psychoactive compound in cannabis. This commercial boom may be recent, but the history of edibles goes way, way back to the origins of the plant thousands of years ago in the Himalayas—in fact, people were eating (and drinking) cannabis long before they were inhaling it. So when did cannabis start being smoked instead—and how did it find itself not only banned, but classified as more dangerous than both opium and meth? With the help of the woman whose family ran America's first edibles empire, we also discover why the pot brownie is America's quintessential edible, and how this humble, slightly mulchy baked good helped make weed legal again. Plus: How today's cannabis chefs are upping the ante and taking weed recipes to new—ahem—highs (please allow us just this one pun).

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Would you say that you and your family are better off or worse off, financially, than you were a year ago? Do you think in 12 months we'll have good times, financially, or bad? Generally speaking, do you think now is a good time or a bad time to buy a house?

These are the kinds of questions baked into the Consumer Sentiment Index. And while the economy has been humming along surprisingly well lately, sentiment has stayed surprisingly low.

Today on the show: We are really bummed about the economy, despite the fact that unemployment and inflation are down. So, what gives? We talk to a former Fed economist trying to get to the heart of this paradox, and travel to Michigan to check in on the place where they check the vibes of the economy.

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The Old Report

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